

Q3 Cloud Infrastructure Spend Analysis

CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE COST OPTIMIZATION REPORT

Prepared By: FinOps Engineering Team Reporting Period: July 1 - August 15, 2026 Cloud Provider: Amazon Web Services (AWS)

Executive Summary: Our monthly AWS expenditure has grown by 22% over the last quarter, reaching an annualized run rate of \$2.4 million. While 8% of this growth is attributed to organic traffic increases, the remaining 14% stems from inefficient resource provisioning and unoptimized storage tiers. This report outlines immediate actions to reduce our monthly burn rate by approximately \$35,000.

Key Areas of Waste:

- Idle EC2 Instances & Overprovisioning:** Analysis using AWS Compute Optimizer identified 42 EC2 instances in the `eu-central-1` region running at less than 5% CPU utilization over a 14-day rolling window. These were primarily oversized `m5.4xlarge` instances spun up for load testing and never decommissioned.
- Unattached Elastic Block Store (EBS) Volumes:** We currently have 1,200 unattached EBS volumes, totaling over 150 TB of provisioned IOPS storage. These orphaned volumes cost the organization roughly \$18,000 per month and serve no active compute nodes.
- S3 Storage Class Inefficiencies:** Over 800 TB of media assets in the `starlight-archive-raw` S3 bucket have not been accessed in over 90 days but remain in the S3 Standard storage tier.

Remediation Plan:

- **Immediate Action:** Engineering has been authorized to terminate all unattached EBS volumes older than 14 days, following a final snapshot backup.
- **Right-Sizing:** Downgrade the identified idle instances from `m5.4xlarge` to `t3.large`, which provides sufficient baseline performance for staging environments.
- **Lifecycle Policies:** Implement an S3 Lifecycle rule to automatically transition objects older than 60 days from S3 Standard to S3 Glacier Deep Archive. This simple policy shift will reduce storage costs for that bucket by 75%.

We anticipate realizing these cost savings fully in the September billing cycle.